

A MOST UNUSUAL AFFAIR

2020

Shortly after my wife, Natalie, and I started dating, I showed her my "sanctuary". I didn't tell her any more than that about its true purpose. I lived in a 3-story house and I had consecrated the entire 3rd floor as a temple to the Thelemic goddess Babalon¹⁷⁹. Babalon has existed since long before the Biblical city of Babylon¹⁸⁰ was conceived. Humans are her children... and what a troublesome bunch we are.

Natalie and I ascended the staircase to the third floor for the first time.

¹⁷⁹ Babalon is the female counterpart to CHAOS. Together, they rule a dimension known as The Supernals, which serves as the womb of creation of consciousness itself in a macrocosmic sense. As such, they are the most exalted, powerful, and oldest of the pantheon.

¹⁸⁰ Note: The spelling of Babalon's name differs from that of the Biblical city because in *The Vision and the Voice*, when Crowley visited the sephirah Binah, Babalon came to him and explicitly corrected the misspelling of her name. This is significant because the new spelling yields a very different numerical value using transliterated Hebrew gematria. This new value establishes a different set of associations with the goddess so that we might understand her better.

She hadn't even climbed the final two steps when she froze in place.

After a couple of seconds, she muttered, "Who is that?!"

I replied, "Who do you see here?"

She said, "There's a woman who appears to be very angry with someone or something I can't see. She's hovering over water, perhaps the ocean, just barely off the coast of a beach. She's wearing a brilliant red robe and screaming at the thing she seems to be chasing."

Me: "Fascinating..."

The vision she was seeing was projected against an undecorated white wall opposite the staircase. Natalie had no formal magickal training, but had seen visions before, so she was startled, but not necessarily afraid of what she was witnessing. However, she had no idea how to interpret it.

I continued, "The woman you're seeing is Babalon. This is her temple." I then gestured toward a figurine standing in a central position atop a bookshelf wearing a crimson silk scarf covering half of her body.

Her: "That's her! But who is she?"

At that point, I launched into a lengthy explanation of who Babalon is and what was most likely happening in the scene she witnessed. Babalon almost always seems to be upset about one thing or another. The object of her ire is certainly something she has dealt with countless times before. I imagine that the extreme boredom resulting from the endless repetition of cyclical behavior - looked at with a lens spanning millennia - fuels much of her anger. demon of some sort that is frustrating her efforts to establish whatever needs to be established in

these early days of a new aeon.

She responded, "Damn, that's hot!"

While that was certainly an unexpected response, an opening is an opening. So, I stoked the flames, "Want to experience something much hotter?"

Being the good sport she always was, "OK..."

We left the temple and went to my bedroom. We disrobed and sat on the bed facing one another.

"Babalon's consort is CHAOS, usually represented as a great beast." I explained as I laid the Lust card¹⁸¹ from the Thoth tarot deck in front of her. "Babalon is already here. If you wish to understand her much better, simply call her into you. I will invoke CHAOS and we can just sit back and let them do what they wish."

"Are you serious?" she retorted with a worried look in her eyes.

"Oh yes. You're in good hands. Nothing bad will happen to you."

"OK..."

And with that, we permitted these high Gods who oversaw the creation of Earth access to our bodies. We made no attempt to place any formal constraints on them; they are old in the extreme and know how to behave. While we lost direct control of our bodies, we could still observe what was going on through our eyes as usual, but also feel

¹⁸¹ The "Lust" card from the Thoth tarot depicts Babalon riding atop a great beast that represents CHAOS.

their presence and the unfathomable amount of energy they were accumulating together in their love-dance. Unsurprisingly, their sex is on the rough side. But fortunately, they remembered to pull back before injuring either of us. When it was over, they bid us a gracious farewell. The whole thing took about an hour or so; we weren't exactly watching the clock.

Natalie later told me that was the most intense magickal experience of her life.

I replied, "I hope so. Because I'm not sure how to top that!"

That was our third date.

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Natalie went on to have many more encounters with Babalon though she never revealed anything to me about the nature of those communications.

One day, Natalie came to me and said, "Babalon taught me a song."

My ears perked up immediately. "Were there lyrics? Can you recall them?"

"Most of them were in another language. I'm sure I would butcher it if I tried to sing it."

I was already getting out recording equipment but she wouldn't do it. Not a single note escaped her lips.

Here's the thing, Babalon doesn't speak to men. And if you ever

witness her speaking to a woman, you'll quickly realize why. It was not atypical of Babalon to threaten Natalie's life instead of just saying "hello"! She's extremely harsh and abrasive. But to her, we're ridiculously over-sensitive.

But you see the problem, right? Most men, when having their life threatened, perceive that they have now entered a mortal combat scenario. A two-men-enter-but-only-one-leaves kind of thing. But when faced with a god older than time itself, one's odds of being victorious are impossibly low.

Don't be fooled into thinking, "Oh, she's just an anthropomorphization of various archetypal constructs based on the elemental laws that govern the Universe." I can't say for sure whether she is or not. But if she is, then those archetypal constructs *can kill you!* That much she made clear to me in one of the two very brief exchanges I had with her.

As far as I can tell, her consort, CHAOS, doesn't communicate. Or if he does, it's not in a manner perceptible by humans.